

Chapter 6: Information and Communication Technology and Society

This chapter explores the profound impact of ICT on entertainment, as well as the ethical, legal, and health considerations that arise in a digital society.

6.1 ICT in Entertainment

Modern film production and gaming have been transformed by advanced technologies:

- **3D Technology:** Enhances realism by adding a third dimension, typically requiring specialized spectacles for viewing.
- **Holographic Image Processing:** Used to display recorded scenes elsewhere, often creating realistic and immersive visual effects.
- **Animation:** Evolution from basic sketches to complex computer-generated cartoon films.

6.2 Ethical and Legal Issues

- **Software Piracy:** The unauthorized copying, distribution, or use of software.
- **Copyright:** Legal protection for original works (music, art, software) to prevent unauthorized use.
- **Privacy:** The right of individuals to protect their personal information from unauthorized access.
- **Cyber Crimes:** Illegal activities conducted via the internet, such as hacking, phishing, and identity theft.

6.3 Health and Safety Issues

Prolonged or incorrect use of ICT equipment can lead to physical ailments:

- **Musculoskeletal Problems:** Back, neck, and shoulder pain caused by poor posture while using computers.
- **Repetitive Stress Injury (RSI):** Pain extending from the shoulder to fingers due to repetitive movements and incorrect posture.
- **Carpal Tunnel Syndrome (CTS):** Numbness and pain in the fingers caused by pressure on the wrist, often from improper keyboard or mouse placement.
- **Computer Vision Syndrome (CVS):** Eye strain, blurred vision, and headaches resulting from staring at screens for extended periods.

6.4 Infrastructure Protection

Protecting ICT assets involves several layers of security:

- **Physical Security:** Protecting hardware from theft or environmental damage (e.g., using locks or fire extinguishers).
- **Software Security:** Using Firewalls, Anti-virus software, and regular updates to protect against malware.
- **Network Security:** Securing data transmission through encryption and secure passwords.